

T-740-SPMM Project A: The Team

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Executive Summary

This report is about the formation of a team in the Software Project Management course at Reykjavik University. It discusses the team, team members' skills, schedule and rules. The diverse backgrounds of team members are discussed, as well as what motivates them and what makes them achieve a flow state.

Moreover, the team demonstrates a well-balanced mix of technical and communication skills, with each member contributing complementary strengths. Overall, the team shows strong collaboration potential and a foundation for effective project execution.

Besides, the team holds a meeting once a week for planning and synchronization. Minutes are taken in every meeting to track topics and attendance. Discussions about tasks and delegations will be done. Every team member has an opportunity to bring their topic and concerns. A meeting is adjourned when consensus is reached.

Furthermore, rules are outlined, such as weekly task planning and delegation, maintaining meeting logs, attendance and notifications. Additionally, the report discusses professional and open communication, completion of tasks and project deadlines and rule violations.

So far, the project has been steadily progressing with dedication to rules and open communication from team members, despite minor challenges along the way. With continued commitment to the schedule and rules, the project and team work will run smoothly in subsequent project phases.

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1 Introduction

Teamwork has never been as important as it is today. Within our globally connected world, projects have been getting bigger, increasing in complexity and expanding beyond borders [1], [2]. To ensure their success, project management relies on clear organization, structured collaboration, and well-defined rules [3]. In this context, this project report documents the team, schedule and rules for the T-740-SPMM projects to enhance collaboration and enable smooth project progress. The report first introduces the team, schedule, contribution map and rules in section 2, with section 3 concluding the report.

2 Main

2.1 Team Members

Kristján Orri Ragnarsson

Kristján is a Master's student at Reykjavík University. While on an exchange to Singapore during his Bachelor's, he found interest in cybersecurity research. Currently in his Master's, he is focusing on cybersecurity. He followed several courses related to cybersecurity, mentored a Bachelor's group working on a cybersecurity thesis and wrote a report on the topic of exposed network services in Greenland.

Also, Kristján finds motivation in interesting and challenging projects. His flow state is reached with clear project goals, within a relaxed and distraction-free environment.

Julie Bauer

Julie is from the Netherlands. Her background is rather diverse. She did her Bachelor's in Liberal Arts and Sciences at Maastricht University, a studies in which courses in a range variety of topics can be chosen. She initially followed courses in political sciences, environmental sciences, poetry and chemistry, after which she decided to follow a path in Data Science and AI. Therefore, she chose to do a Master's in Data Science for Decision-Making, in which she focuses mostly on Natural Language Processing.

What motivates Julie are interesting projects and shared responsibility and open communication among team members. A flow state is achieved in Julie when project goals are clear and deadlines are fixed, as she performs well under a bit of pressure.

Tinna María Þorleifsdóttir

Tinna has lived in Iceland her entire life. She studied innovation and art at Verzlunarskóli Íslands, as she has always loved art and being creative. When it came time to choose a university program, Tinna recognized her strong interest in math, problem-solving, and project-based work, which led her to pursue a Bachelor's degree in Computer Science in 2023. She is now in her third year. Although she had no prior background in computer science, she has developed a strong passion for the subject and has been an active part of the department's social life. Tinna is most productive and experiences a state of flow when she has a clear deadline and works in a focused, collaborative environment where she can solve challenging problems with her team.

Stella Stefánsdóttir

Stella is from Iceland and graduated with a Bachelor of Science in Nursing from the University of Iceland in 2022. She works in a medical-surgical department specializing in urology and abdominal care. Through her experience, she developed an interest in digital health solutions and decided to pursue a Master's in Computer Science with a focus on Digital Health. She enjoys learning new skills that she can apply and combine with her healthcare knowledge. Stella reaches a state of flow when she works in a structured and focused environment where goals and expectations are clear. She is most productive in the evening when there are no distractions and she can concentrate fully on her work. In her professional experience, she also finds that open communication supports this focus and helps maintain clarity and progress.

Leonardo Salpini

Leonardo is an exchange student from Italy studying for a Master's degree in Computer Science at the University of Camerino. His studies focus on Artificial Intelligence (AI), particularly on AI algorithms. He has a Bachelor's degree in Computer Science from the same university, where he specialized in programming with a strong emphasis on Java. He also has experience with Python through various projects and his thesis. His undergraduate coursework also included classes in networking, software engineering, and web development. During his undergraduate studies, Leonardo completed a university internship at TelematicaInformatica in Turin. During this time, he and a colleague developed a web application for internal company use, utilizing Spring Boot and React. Leonardo finds motivation in projects that are engaging and technical challenging. A state of flow is reached when working toward well-defined goals, particularly in environments where tasks are clearly divided among group members. He performs best when there is open communication among team members. This enhances his productivity and ensures consistent progress and effective teamwork.

2.2 Schedule

This section outlines the team's work schedule and ways of working. One-hour in-person meetings will be held every week on Monday at 15:10. If necessary, extra meetings will be scheduled in-person or online via Zoom. In weekly meetings, progress will be discussed, as well as positive and negative aspects of the project so far. Also, there will be room for questions of team members, and the meetings always conclude with a delegation of future tasks. Moreover, a meeting agenda will be prepared before every meeting, to make the gathering flow more smoothly and make sure that all important points will be covered. This agenda depends on the phase and progress of the project.

Furthermore, team members will be assigned roles during meetings that rotate weekly. These include: Discussion leader, note taker, planner and progress keeper. First, the discussion leader will lead discussions, according to the daily agenda, make sure to include all team members, and ask regular questions to ensure the team is on the same page and everyone is involved. Second, the note taker logs meetings by taking minutes of the meeting. These are written down in a shared Google Document that all team members can access. Besides, the planner takes responsibility for the planning process during team meetings. This can consist of planning extra team meetings when necessary, setting internal deadlines for the team, delegating work, and planning the amount of weekly work. Lastly, the progress keeper keeps track of the progress that has been made, including

which tasks have been finished and which still have to be.

While group members have different roles, the decision-making process remains democratic, involving all group members equally. When a team member is absent, they will be updated after the meeting and asked virtually if they agree with team decisions. In this way, everyone stays included and that responsibilities and decisions are shared fairly.

In addition to team meetings, the team will stay in touch through a shared group chat on WhatsApp. This group chat is used to ask quick questions, share relevant documents, or provide small updates in between meetings. The goal is to ensure smooth communication and continuous collaboration, necessary when working on a team project.

2.3 Contribution Map

Table 2.1 summarizes the team members' self-assessments across various skill areas. The grading scale ranges from 0 (no knowledge), 1 (some knowledge), 2 (extensive knowledge), 3 (some skills), 4 (extensive skills), 5 (some competencies), to 6 (extensive competencies). This contribution map highlights individual expertise, as well as areas for further improvement within the team.

Member	Communication	Critical thinking	Problem-solving	Talking to users	Creativity
Kristján	3	3	3	2	3
Julie	4	4	4	3	4
Tinna	4	3	3	4	5
Stella	4	3	3	3	4
Leonardo	3	3	3	2	2

Member	Decision-making	Programming	UI/UX Design	Research	Managing
Kristján	3	5	1	4	1
Julie	3	3	0	5	3
Tinna	3	3	4	3	3
Stella	3	0	0	4	4
Leonardo	3	5	1	3	2

Table 2.1: Contribution Map of Team members graded on a scale from 0–6

2.4 Rules

We have established the following guidelines to promote effective teamwork and a productive team environment. Although exceptions may be made, following these rules is crucial for the success of our collaboration.

2.4.1 Meeting Attendance and Notification

If a member is unable to attend a scheduled meeting, they have to notify the team as soon as possible, ideally at least two hours in advance. This allows others to adjust their plans and helps the team decide whether to proceed or reschedule.

2.4.2 Maintain Meeting Logs

We will keep a written record of all meetings. These logs will serve as a reference point for tracking decisions, assigned task and progress.

2.4.3 Weekly Task Planning and Delegation

Each meeting will include a dedicated session to plan and delegate tasks for the upcoming week. The objective is to clearly define each task and assign a team member to be responsible for it so that the project progresses smoothly.

2.4.4 Professional and Open Communication

It is crucial to be kind and respectful in all our interactions. We encourage all team members to communicate openly and share their ideas and concerns. Every idea should be evaluated on its merit and not dismissed without consideration, as this is essential to building a trusting and effective team.

2.4.5 Punctuality

Being on time for meetings is important. A member is allowed to be late with a grace period of up to 30 minutes with notice.

2.4.6 Completion of Tasks

All assigned tasks must be completed to the best of each team member's ability in alignment with each member's skills, knowledge, and expertise. In the event a team member cannot complete the task, the member is required to inform the team. Either assistance can be provided or the task will be delegated to another member to maintain project progress in a timely manner.

2.4.7 Respect Project Deadlines

Tasks are attempted to be completed within the given set time without delays. Each member is responsible for their delegated tasks and is asked to complete them within a set timeline. Members are required to inform the team about their progress or completion of their task. If foreseen that deadline will not be met, members are asked to notify the team two days before the deadline to redistribute the task(s) among other members.

2.4.8 Violations of Rules

If rules are not adhered to or expectations are not met, the team will address the issue internally through open discussion and mutual understanding. If matters do not resolve internally, external support may be necessary as a last resort.

3 Conclusion

The report shows the diverse backgrounds and varied skill sets of team members, which is valuable for a project that requires varied expertise. This is particularly important in a software project, where technical skills are important alongside skills such as creativity and communication. The diversity of the team allows tasks to be assigned according to team members' expertise in subsequent stages of the project.

Moreover, the teamwork has been going well so far. Team meetings have been held on Mondays with members taking up specific tasks during meetings. Also, team members have adhered to the set-out rules by attending meetings, being punctual, communicating openly and professionally, taking logs, completing tasks, planning and delegating tasks and respecting project deadlines. Additionally, communication beyond meetings was clear and prompt.

At the same time, some challenges have arisen during phase A. Report details were sometimes unclear, requiring brain storming to resolve. Also, delegating tasks and distributing work evenly proved more difficult in a large group, often taking more time than anticipated.

Despite minor challenges, the team has been making steady progress throughout phase A. The team is confident it can overcome obstacles and perform successfully in the next stages of the project if commitment to rules remains strong and diverse strengths of members are leveraged throughout the project.

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